A STUDY OF PASSENGER SATISFACTION FACTOR ON AIRLINE PERFORMANCE

A PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this project report titled **"A STUDY OF PASSENGER SATISFACTION FACTOR ON AIRLINE PERFORMANCE"** is the bonafide work of **"MOHAMAD NASEER M (22238022)"** who carried out the project work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported here does not form part of any other project / research work on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

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I, MOHAMAD NASEER M (22238022) a bonafide student of School of Management, Hindustan Institute of Technology & Science, Chennai would like to declare that the Final project entitled, "A STUDY OF PASSENGER SA SATISFACTION FACTOR ON AIRLINE PERFORMANCE" in partial fulfilment of Master of Business Administration course of the Hindustan Institute of Technology & Science is my original work.

SIGNATURE

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ABSTRACT

Customer satisfaction has become an important tool in developing customer satisfaction measures and establishing business processes that link quality with customer satisfaction. In recent years, there has been a considerable increase in interest in defining, measuring, and developing customer satisfaction to meet the competitive challenge among industries. The main objective of this study is to identify the level of satisfaction of the passengers and to know the quality of services provided by the airline companies and the key factors that derive customer satisfaction.

This study investigates factors of airline satisfaction by generating marketing actions which include the problem and opportunities identification in the airline industry. It also helps in evaluating the previous action of work and compares the past performance with the real objective of the airline industry and focuses on developing a better idea for the future to improve the service quality by investigating customer satisfaction for several a priori market segments identified by using the survey method which accounts for the multi-step nature of the airline choice process.

The collected data is then filtered and the unnecessary data are dispensed. The data is then grouped according to several variables used for measurement. Data can be analyzed by using several methods. This survey helps the airlines to understand the most important factors that have a direct impact on customer satisfaction. So, airlines should learn from their experiences, only then, the company can make a profit and have good relations with the customers.

CHAPTER - 1

Chapter 1- Introduction

Air travel has always been classified as one of the more intangible service industries. Aviation plays an essential role in the economic progress of a nation as it is viewed as a necessary link not only for international voyages and trade but also for providing connectivity to different parts of the country. It is one of the vital parts of the infrastructure of the country and has outcomes for the development of tourism and trade, the opening of inaccessible areas of the country, and for providing stimulus to business activity and economic growth. Nowadays, the competition among businesses working within the airline industry has gotten to be exceedingly strong. This has brought about distinctive sorts of impediments for the airline industry. For instance, companies are presently required to contribute large sums of assets in promoting and advancing activities to attract more clients. Moreover, airline companies are required to offer high-quality administrations that take a toll on attracting new customers, now ordinary citizens easily access the aviation service from their respective air terminals. In a highly competitive environment, the provision of high-quality services to passengers is the core competitive advantage for an airline's profitability and sustained growth. In the past decade, as the air transportation market has become even more challenging, many airlines have turned to focus on airline service quality to increase service satisfaction. Service quality conditions influence a firm’s competitive advantage by retaining customer patronage, and with this comes market share. Delivering high-quality service to passengers is essential for airline survival, so airlines need to understand what passengers expect from their services. Service quality can be defined as a consumer’s overall impression of the relative efficiency of the organization and its services. Understanding exactly what customers expect is the most crucial step in defining and delivering high-quality service.

So, to cope with this competitive challenge, customer satisfaction has become the primary goal of the aviation industry to survive in this competitive market. Competitors that are prospering in the new global economy recognize that measuring customer satisfaction and understanding the needs and satisfaction of potential customers is the key factor to retaining customers. Only by doing so can they hold on to the customers and understand how to better attract new customers and retain existing customers. The competitors will be successfully able to recognize that customer satisfaction data obtained by a customer survey is a critical and strategic weapon that can bring increased market share and increased profits by way of utilizing the available resources by keeping in view the perception and the expectations of the customers.

1.1 Industry Profile

The term 'aviation' is most used to describe mechanical air transportation, which is carried out using an aircraft. The two main aircraft types are airplanes and helicopters, but most modern definitions of the word 'aviation' extend beyond this to include unmanned aircraft, such as drones. The aviation industry can be described as all the industry that surrounds these activities.

The aviation industry refers to the business sector responsible for the operation of aircraft, manufacturing of aircraft and related components, as well as providing air transport services for passengers and cargo. This industry encompasses a wide range of activities, including commercial airlines, private aviation, aircraft manufacturing, maintenance, and support services. It plays a crucial role in global transportation, trade, and tourism, facilitating efficient and rapid movement of people and goods across the world.

The importance of the modern aviation industry is difficult to overstate. Still, one of the main reasons for this importance is the globalized nature of the industry, helping to connect different continents, countries, and cultures. As a result, global aviation has been key in facilitating efficient travel to distant places, enriching many lives in the process.

1.2 Company Profile

THE AIRPORTS AUTHORITY OF INDIA:

Airports Authority of India (AAI) was constituted by an Act of Parliament and came into being on 1st April 1995 by merging erstwhile National Airports Authority and International Airports Authority of India. The merger brought into existence a single Organization entrusted with the responsibility of creating, upgrading, maintaining, and managing civil aviation infrastructure both on the ground and air space in the country.

AAI manages a total of 137 airports which include 24 International airports (3 Civil Enclaves), 10 Custom Airports (4 Civil Enclaves) and 103 Domestic airports (23 Civil Enclaves). AAI provides air navigation services over 2.8 million square nautical miles of air space. During the year 2019-20, AAI handled aircraft movement of 1314.23 thousand [International 156.0 & Domestic 1158.23], Passengers handled 159.59 million [International 22.26 & Domestic 137.33] and the cargo handled 909.32 thousand MT [International 452.46 & Domestic 456.85]. Further, all Indian airports taken together have handled aircraft movement of 2587.05 thousand [International 431.85 & Domestic 2155.20], Passengers handled 341.05

million [International 66.54& Domestic 274.51] and the cargo handled 3328.63 thousand MT [International 2003.12 & Domestic 1325.51].

1.PassengerFacilities:

The main functions of AAI inter-alia include construction, modification & management of passenger terminals, development & management of cargo terminals, development & maintenance of apron infrastructure including runways, parallel taxiways, apron etc., Provision of Communication, Navigation and Surveillance which includes provision of DVOR / DME, ILS, ATC radars, visual aids etc., provision of air traffic services, provision of passenger facilities and related amenities at its terminals thereby ensuring safe and secure operations of aircraft, passenger and cargo in the country.

2. Air Navigation Services:

In tune with global approach to modernization of Air Navigation infrastructure for seamless navigation across state and regional boundaries, AAI has been going ahead with its plans for transition to satellite based Communication, Navigation, Surveillance and Air Traffic Management. A number of co-operation agreements and memoranda of co-operation have been signed with US Federal Aviation Administration, US Trade & Development Agency, European Union, Air Services Australia and the French Government Co-operative Projects and Studies initiated to gain from their experience. Through these activities more and more executives of AAI are being exposed to the latest technology, modern practices & procedures being adopted to improve the overall performance of Airports and Air Navigation Services. Induction of latest state-of-the-art equipment, both as replacement and old equipment and also as new facilities to improve standards of safety of airports in the air is a continuous process. Adoptions of new and improved procedure go hand in hand with induction of new equipment. Some of the major initiatives in this direction are introduction of Reduced Vertical Separation Minima (RVSM) in India air space to increase airspace capacity and reduce congestion in the air; implementation of GPS And Geo Augmented Navigation (GAGAN) jointly with ISRO which when put to operation would be one of the four such systems in the world.

3.Security:

The continuing security environment has brought into focus the need for strengthening security of vital installations. There was thus an urgent need to revamp the security at airports not only to thwart any misadventure but also to restore confidence of traveling public in the security of

air travel, which was shaken after 9/11 tragedy. With this in view, a number of steps were taken including deployment of CISF for airport security, CCTV surveillance system at sensitive airports, latest and state-of-the-art X-ray baggage inspection systems, premier security & surveillance systems. Smart Cards for access control to vital installations at airports are also being considered to supplement the efforts of security personnel at sensitive airports.

4.Aerodrome Facilities:

In Airports Authority of India, the basic approach to planning of airport facilities has been adopted to create capacity ahead of demand in our efforts. Towards implementation of this strategy, a few projects for extension and strengthening of runway, taxi track and aprons at different airports has been taken up. Extension of runway to 7500 ft. has been taken up to support operation for Airbus-320/Boeing 737-800 category of aircrafts at all airports.

5.HRD Training:

A large pool of trained and highly skilled manpower is one of the major assets of Airports Authority of India. Development and Technological enhancements and consequent refinement of operating standards and procedures, new standards of safety and security and improvements in management techniques call for continuing training to update the knowledge and skill of officers and staff. For this purpose, AAI has a number of training establishments, viz. NIAMAR in Delhi, CATC in Allahabad, Fire Training Centres at Delhi & Kolkata for in-house training of its engineers, Air Traffic Controllers, Rescue & Fire Fighting personnel etc. NIAMAR & CATC are members of ICAO TRAINER programme under which they share Standard Training Packages (STP) from a central pool for imparting training on various subjects. Both CATC & NIAMAR have also contributed a few STPs to the Central pool under ICAO TRAINER programme. Foreign students have also been participating in the training programme being conducted by this institution.

6. IT Implementation:

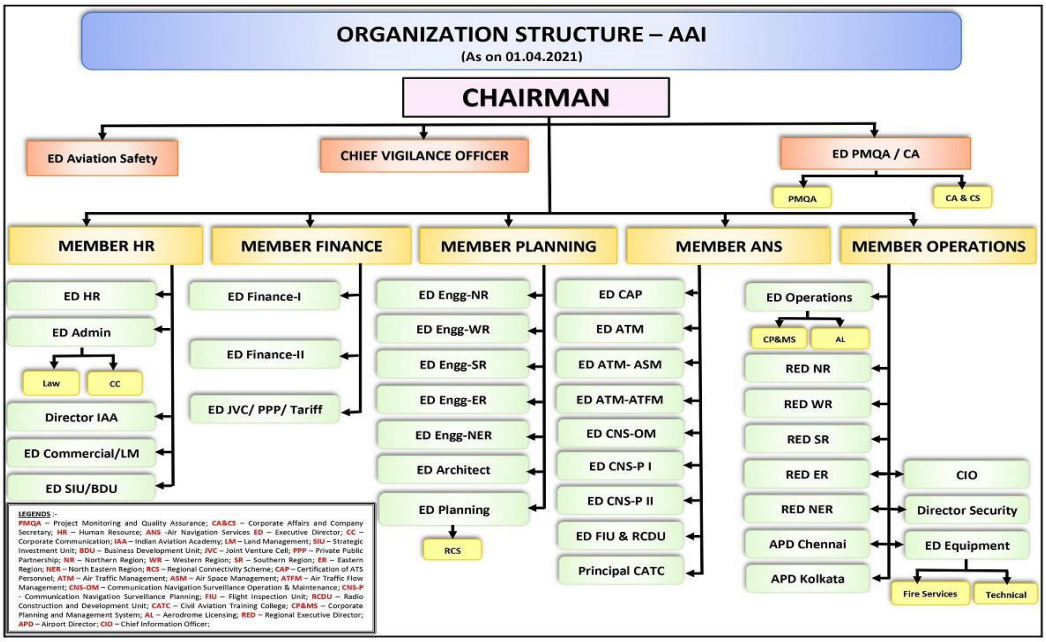
Information Technology holds the key to operational and managerial efficiency, transparency, and employee productivity. AAI initiated a programme to indoctrinate IT culture among its employees and this is most powerful tool to enhance efficiency in the organization. AAI website with domain name www.airportsindia.org.in or www.aai.aero is a popular website giving a host of information about the organization besides domestic and international flight information of interest to the public in general and passengers in particular.

THE FUNCTIONS OF AAI ARE AS FOLLOWS:

- Design, Development, Operation and Maintenance of international and domestic airports and civil enclaves
- Control and Management of the Indian airspace extending beyond the territorial limits of the country, as accepted by ICAO.
- Construction, Modification and Management of passenger terminals.
- Development and Management of cargo terminals at international and domestic airports.
- Provision of passenger facilities and information system at the passenger terminals at airports.
- Expansion and strengthening of operation area, viz. Runways, Aprons, Taxiway etc.
- Provision of visual aids.
- Provision of Communication and Navigation aids, viz. ILS, DVOR, DME, Radar etc.

ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE OF AIRPORTS AUTHORITY OF INDIA:

The Administrator of the Civil Aviation Training College (CATC) Prayag Raj is designated as Principal, who is of the rank of Executive Director in the Airports Authority of India. This organizational structure is updated on 2021.



BREIF ABOUT CHENNAI INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT:

The airport is the 5th busiest airport in India, and 3rd by international traffic. It was also 49th busiest airport in Asia in 2018 making it one of the four major airports in India under the top 50 list of 2018.[4] In financial year 2022-23, the airport handled over 18 million passengers.[5] The airport is served by the airport metro station of the Chennai Metro and the Tirusulam railway station of the Chennai Suburban Railway system. To cope with the passenger traffic, two new terminals, including one satellite terminal, are under construction to handle 40 million passengers per year.[6] Once completed, it will be India's first airport to have a satellite terminal.

DEPARTMENTS IN AIRPORTS AUTHORITY OF INDIA:

The airports authority of India (AAI) consists of various departments, each responsible for specific functions and aspects of airport management and development. Here are some of the key departments within the AAI:

1. AIRPORTS OPERATIONS DEPARTMENT: This department oversees the day-to-day operations of airports, including terminal management, ground handling services, airsides operations, passengers' facilities, and coordination with airlines and other stakeholders.

2. AIR TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT DEPARTMENT: The Air Traffic Management department is responsible for providing air traffic control services. It includes air traffic control towers, area control centers, radar services, flight data processing, and communication system.

3. ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT: The engineering department is responsible for the design, construction, and maintenance of airport infrastructure. It manages projects related to the construction and renovation of runways, taxiways, terminals, airfield lighting, navigation aids, and other facilities.

4. FINANCE DEPARTMENT: The finance department handles financial management, budgeting, accounting, and financial planning for the AAI. It ensures the efficient allocation and utilization of financial resources and manages revenue generation, tariff determination, and financial reporting.

5. HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT: The human resources management department is responsible for managing the recruitment, training and development of AAI employees.

It looks after the personnel policies, employee's welfare, performance management, and industrial relations.

6. PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT: The department focuses on strategies planning, airport development for the future, and long-term infrastructure planning. It conducts feasibility studies, prepares master plans, and manages the development and expansion of airports in line with the growth requirements of the aviation sector.
7. INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY DEPARTMENT: The IT department is responsible for managing the technological infrastructure, systems and applications used by the AAI. It ensures the smooth operation of information technology services, including airport management systems, communication networks, and data management.
8. COMERECIAL DEPARTMENT: The Commercial Department deals with commercial activities at airports, including leasing of commercial spaces, advertising, concessions, and retail management. It manages contracts with airlines, retailers, and services providers, ensuring compliance with regulations and revenue generation.
9. SECURITY DEPARTMENT: The Security Department is responsible for ensuring the security of airport and passengers. It looks after the security measures, threat assessment, access control, and coordination with relevant security agencies.
10. CARGO MANAGEMENT: The Cargo Department is responsible for ensuring the management and facilitating the movement of cargo through airports across the country. This department promotes efficient and effective cargo operations, contributing to the growth of the logistics and trade sector in the country.

These department work collaboratively to manage and develop airports, provide efficient services, ensures safety and security, and contribute to the overall growth and success of the Indian aviation sector under the preview of the airports authority of India.

The Vision of the company

To be World's leading Airport Developer, Operator and Air Navigation Service provider.

The Mission of the company

To enhance air connectivity across the nation and be an Environment conscious sustainable

organization using the state of the art and indigenous technology for cost effective, modern, safe airport operations and air navigation services.

1.3 NEED FOR STUDY:

In today's fiercely competitive airline industry, ensuring passenger satisfaction is paramount for maintaining a competitive edge and fostering customer loyalty. With the rise of globalization and increasing demand for air travel, airlines are under immense pressure to deliver exceptional service experiences to passengers while also optimizing operational efficiency. Customer satisfaction has emerged as a critical metric, directly influencing an airline's reputation, market share, and financial performance.

Despite its significance, the intricacies of passenger satisfaction and its impact on airline performance remain complex and multifaceted. While airlines invest considerable resources in improving service quality, understanding the specific factors that drive passenger satisfaction is essential for crafting targeted strategies and enhancing overall performance.

This study aims to address this gap by conducting a comprehensive analysis of passenger satisfaction factors and their implications for airline performance. By delving into the nuances of customer preferences, service quality, and the overall passenger experience, this research seeks to provide actionable insights for airline companies to enhance their service offerings and foster long-term customer relationships.

Moreover, as the airline industry continues to evolve amidst technological advancements, changing consumer behaviors, and market dynamics, the need for a nuanced understanding of passenger satisfaction becomes even more pronounced. By leveraging empirical data and robust analytical methodologies, this study endeavors to contribute valuable knowledge to the field, facilitating informed decision-making and strategic planning within the airline industry.

The significance of this study lies in its potential to elucidate the key drivers of passenger satisfaction, thereby empowering airlines to refine their service delivery processes, optimize resource allocation, and ultimately, thrive in an increasingly competitive market landscape.

1.4 OBJECTIVE OF THE STUDY

The study aims to comprehensively analyze passenger satisfaction factors and their influence on airline performance. It seeks to identify and prioritize key drivers of passenger satisfaction, evaluate the quality of services provided by airline companies, and examine the relationship between passenger satisfaction and airline performance metrics such as market share and revenue generation. Additionally, the research will propose marketing actions to enhance airline satisfaction levels, provide practical recommendations for improving service quality and customer satisfaction, and contribute to academic literature and industry knowledge on the topic. Through empirical analysis and literature reviews, the study endeavors to offer actionable insights for airlines to optimize customer experiences and competitiveness within the industry.

The main focuses of the study:

- The main objective of this study is to examine the satisfaction of passengers on service quality of different airlines.

- To explore the level of passengers‟ satisfaction with the service quality on Indian airlines in terms of three dimensions of service quality instrument i.e., in-fight services, in-flight digital services, and back-office operations.

- To elucidate the relationship between service qualities delivered to passengers and their satisfaction as to different class of journey.

- To examine the demographic profile of the respondents and their satisfaction on the services rendered by the airliners.

1.5 SCOPE OF THE STUDY:

This study focuses on analyzing passenger satisfaction factors in the airline industry, covering various types of airlines and geographic regions. It examines factors such as ticket booking, in-flight experience, and post-flight services, considering passenger demographics and preferences. The study also explores the impact of passenger satisfaction on airline performance metrics like market share and revenue. Methods include surveys, interviews, and observational research. Limitations include a focus on passenger perspectives and potential

sample biases. Overall, the study aims to provide actionable insights for airlines to enhance customer experiences and competitiveness.

- To study the customer satisfaction and value.
- Having high performance of the business.
- Attracting and relating customers.
- Adding the benefits people satisfaction.
- Implementing total quantity management.

1.6 LIMITATIONS OF THE STUDY:

While this study aims to provide valuable insights into passenger satisfaction in the airline industry, several limitations should be acknowledged. Firstly, the research primarily focuses on passenger perspectives, potentially overlooking the viewpoints of other stakeholders such as airline staff and regulators. Additionally, the findings may be influenced by factors such as sample size, survey methodology, and regional variations, which could affect the generalizability of the results. Despite these limitations, efforts will be made to mitigate biases and ensure the reliability and validity of the findings.

CHAPTER 2

Review of Literature

Passenger satisfaction in airline operations has become critically important and Dennett, Ineson, Stone, and Colgate (2000) suggest that as competition created by deregulation has become more intense, service quality in the airline industry has also received more attention. Airline companies also attempted to differentiate their services through the use of computerized reservation systems which were also designed to create customer loyalty in the distribution channels (Lee and Cunningham, 1996). However, despite the airlines‟ efforts to differentiate their services, an extensive survey of frequent fliers conducted by Ott (1993) revealed that consumers did not perceive any difference from one carrier to another.

Cronin and Taylor (1992) originate empirical provision for the idea that perceived service quality led to satisfaction and argued that service quality was actually an antecedent of consumer satisfaction. Bitner and Hubbert (1994) determined that service encounter satisfaction was quite distinct from overall satisfaction and perceived quality. Service quality will vary; the definitions are all formulated from the customer perspective: that is, what customers perceive are important dimensions of quality. Gronroos (1982) and Parasuraman, Zeithaml and Berry (1988) were the pioneers in the conceptualization of the service quality construct, these authors maintained that the overall perception of quality was a disconfirmation of a customer s expectation and evaluation of a services delivered.

Saha and Theingi (2009) pointed out that the emergence of low-cost airlines has raised concerns on how satisfied are the customers with the services provided. Doyle and Wong (1998) originate that successful companies have a differential advantage in overall company reputation and communicate it as quality to their customers (Solomon, 1985). Often, they are able to command premium prices (Tepeci, 1999). It is found that the most important criterion for customers selecting a bank is reputation (Boyd et al., 1994; Darby, 1999) while Rogerson (1983) stated that good reputation could increase an organization's sales, attract more customers, and reduce customer departures.

Maintaining quality are the main concerns of business today. Providing quality is not a concern of manufacturing companies alone. The delivery of high-quality service becomes a marketing requirement among air carriers as a result of competitive pressure (Ostrowski et al., 1993). Chang and Keller (2002) argue that quality in airline service is difficult to describe and measure due to its heterogeneity, intangibility, and inseparability, and only the customer can truly define service quality in the airline industry (Butler and Keller, 1992). Previous airline service studies are concentrated in modeling the effect of perceived service quality at the aggregate construct level, though examining the effects of individual dimensions of service

attributes has potentially great utility for airline managers (Patterson & Spreng, 1997). The perceptions of airline service quality are quite diverse and do not seem to fit any single existing quality model such as the service quality (Haynes & Percy, 1994).

Several researches are available on customer satisfaction in general and in tourism industry in particular. Many research works have been done on evaluation of service quality in aviation industry. Kearney (1986) was the first researcher who evaluated service quality of airline industry with the perspective of airline customers in his doctoral research. Good service quality results high customer satisfaction level. According to Oliver (1997), "Satisfaction is the consumer's fulfilment response. It is a judgment that a product or service feature, or the product of service itself, provided (or is providing) a pleasurable level of consumption-related fulfilment, including levels of under- or over-fulfilment…. So, Customer satisfaction has become the leading criterion for determining the quality that is delivered to customers through the product/ service and by the accompanying servicing (Vavra, 1997). In the same vein customer satisfaction is essential for corporate survival. Several studies have found that it costs about five times as much in time, money and resources to attract a new customer as it does to retain an existing customer. (Naumann, 1995). So, we can say that customer satisfaction is perceived to be productivity tools and sources of competitive advantage (Reichheld and Sasser 1990; Magrath 1992). Evaluation of service quality could be used as important tool for increasing customer satisfaction.

CHAPTER 3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Data Collection: This study is based on both primary and secondary data. Primary data was collected through a questionnaire. This study covers a sample of 164 respondents and the survey was conducted at the Chennai International Airport Terminal of Tamil Nadu during March-April 2024. Sampling is done by interviewing randomly selected passengers, at different times of the day, on every day of the week, over three weeks. A structured questionnaire was used for data collection The questionnaire was administrated on the various parameters of service quality of airlines in India satisfaction for this study is taken to be after service experience of customers. A higher positive response on a five-point scale is taken to be a measure of customer satisfaction. Their opinion was measured on 5 5-point Likert scale ranging from strongly satisfied (5) to strongly dissatisfied (1). Researchers identified the contact persons representing the airline industry to assist with sample selection and data collection. Exploratory Factor Analysis was issued for measuring airline service quality to determine the dimension of airline service quality. Factor analysis is a general name denoting a class of procedures primarily used for data reduction and summarization.

The airline passenger satisfaction dataset contains 19 features including passenger ID, Name of passenger, Airlines, Date of travel, Age, Gender, Travel Class, Flight Frequency, Check-in process, Onboard service, seat comfort, Cleanliness, Legroom, Food and drink service, cabin Environment, In-flight Entertainment, Baggage Handling, Airline Preference, Overall satisfaction There are 225 data items in this dataset with no missing values. The passenger ratings for service span from 0 to 5.

3.1 METHODOLOGY ADOPTED

Research Meaning:

Research is conducted with a purpose to Identify potential and new customers Understand existing customers Set pragmatic goals Develop productive market strategies Address business challenges Put together a business expansion plan Identify new business opportunities.

Definition of research:

Research is defined as careful consideration of study regarding a particular concern or problem using scientific methods. According to the American sociologist Earl Robert Babbie, “research

is a systematic inquiry to describe, explain, predict, and control the observed phenomenon. It involves inductive and deductive methods."

Meaning of Research Design:

Research design is the framework of research methods and techniques chosen by a researcher. The design allows researchers to hone in on research methods that are suitable for the subject matter and set their studies up for success.

Definition of Research Design:

The research design refers to the overall strategy that you choose to integrate the different components of the study in a coherent and logical way, thereby ensuring you will effectively address the research problem; it constitutes the blueprint for the collection, measurement, and analysis of data.

Sampling Size:

The sample size is 225.

Sample Area:

The sampling area is Chennai International Airport Terminal.

3.2 SOURCES OF DATA COLLECTION

Data Collection:

The data for the study was collected from both the primary source and secondary source.

Primary Data: The primary source of data was collected from observation and questionnaire. All the data was collected through a survey. The data was obtained for the first time by the researcher itself.

Secondary Data: The secondary data that has been recorded and published in a structured format. This can be collected within a short period of time. The information is collected from

the sources of company records, websites, books, internet, journals, newspaper, etc... In this project secondary data was collected from company profile and company website.

3.3 SAMPLING METHODS:

This is the most common method used for data collection. By filling a questionnaire.

● close-ended questions

● open ended questions

Observation:

A structured observation is followed to obtain information about how the customer satisfactions are taken place in the company. Also, by observing the employees during work time.

Questionnaire:

A well-defined and well-structured questionnaire was distributed to the customers to collect information about the Customer satisfaction. The main purpose of collecting questionnaires is to get quantitative and qualitative information about the Customer satisfaction.

Descriptive Research:

In Descriptive Research Design, the scholar explains/describes the situation or case in depth in their research materials. This type of research design is purely on a theoretical basis where the individual collects data, analyses, prepares and then presents it in an understandable manner. It is the most generalized form of research design. To explore one or more variables, a descriptive design might employ a wide range of research approaches. Unlike in experimental research, the researcher does not control or change any of the variables in a descriptive research design; instead, he or she just observes and measures them. In other words, while qualitative research may also be utilized for descriptive reasons, a descriptive method of research design is typically regarded as a sort of quantitative research. To guarantee that the results are legitimate and dependable, the study design should be properly constructed.

Correlation Research:

A correlational research design investigates correlations between variables without allowing the researcher to control or manipulate any of them. Correlational studies reveal the magnitude and/or direction of a link between two (or more) variables. Correlational studies or correlational study design might have either a positive, negative or zero.

Hypothesis used for the Study:

H0 - there is a satisfaction of passengers on service quality of different airline

H1- there is no satisfaction of passengers on service quality of different airlines

3.4 STATISTICAL TOOLS

Percent analysis, Correlation, Descriptive frequence statistics were performed to analyse the Data set. IBM SPSS 23 software was used for running various tests. The significance of the test was set for 5% with 95 % on confidence.

Survey Programming Tool for the Study

The survey is being conducted through online forms- a questionnaire using Google Forms. This is a computer-assisted interviewing application that helps in the transformation of a 'Pen and paper personal interview' (PAPI) into digital work.

CHAPTER 4

4.1 DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

DATA ANALYSIS:

Data analysis is done using SPSS software. Using the descriptive method and correlation method.

Data analysis is a process of inspecting, cleansing, transforming, and modelling data with the goal of discovering useful information, informing conclusions, and supporting decision-making.

FREQUENCY:

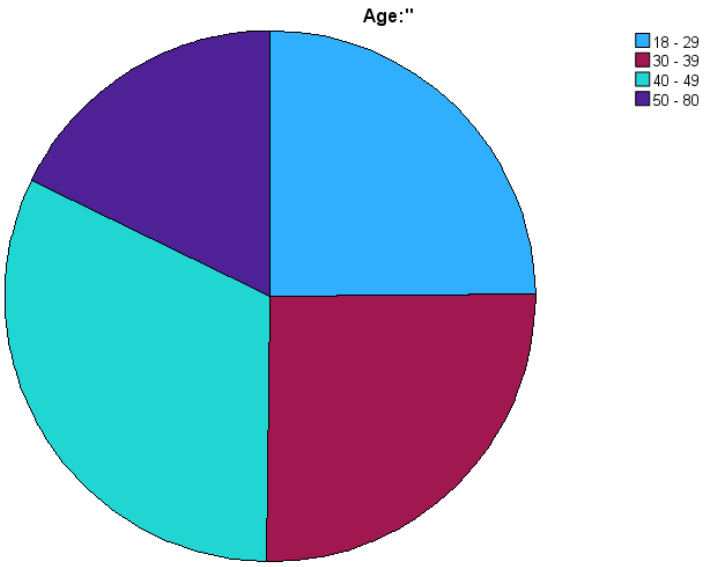
Statistics

Age:"

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Age:"

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	18 - 29	56	24.9	24.9	24.9
	30 - 39	57	25.3	25.3	50.2
	40 - 49	72	32.0	32.0	82.2
	50 - 80	40	17.8	17.8	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 32% Customer are Age between 40-49 years, 25.3% customers are 30-39 years, 24.9% Customers are 18-29 years and 17.8% Customers are 50-80 years.

TABLE:4.1.2 Gender of the respondent

FREQUENCY:

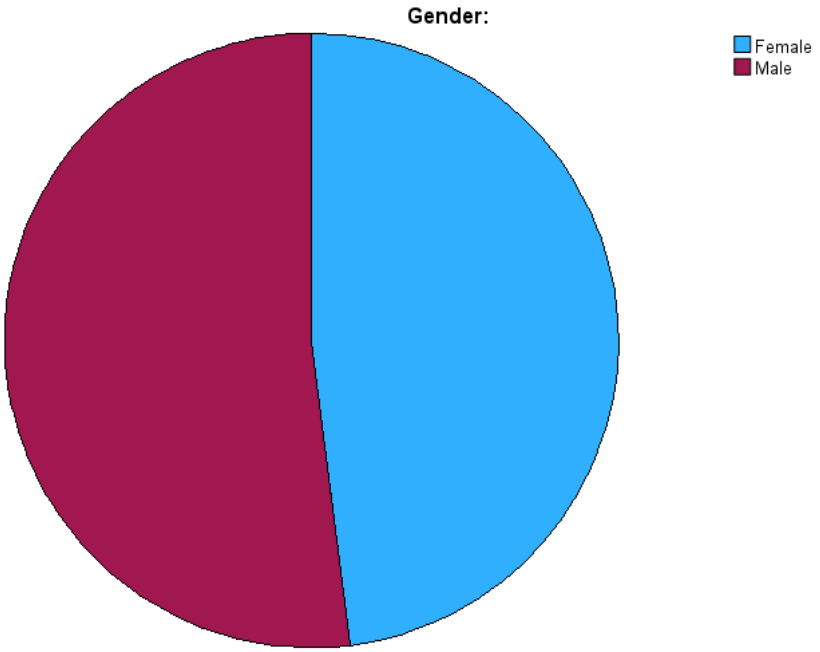
Statistics

Gender:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Gender:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	Female	108	48.0	48.0	48.0
	Male	117	52.0	52.0	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents' 52% are male and 48% are female.

TABLE:4.1.3 Travel class of the respondent

FREQUENCY:

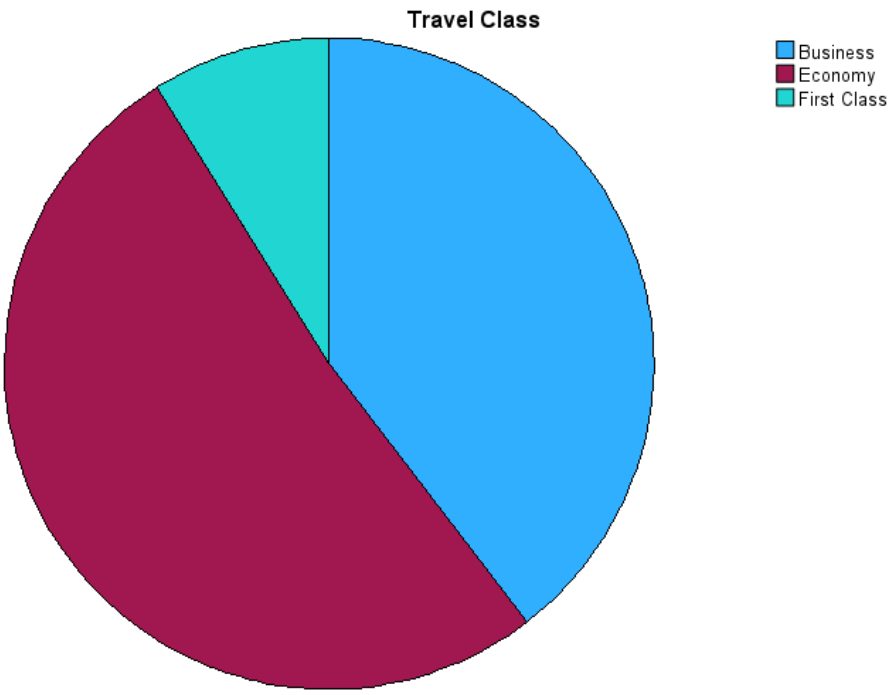
Statistics

Travel Class

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Travel Class

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	Business	89	39.6	39.6	39.6
	Economy	116	51.6	51.6	91.1
	First Class	20	8.9	8.9	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents' 51.6% are travelling in Economy class, 39.6% percent are travelling in Business class and 8.6% are travelling in First class

TABLE:4.1.4 Flight Frequency of the respondent

FREQUENCY:

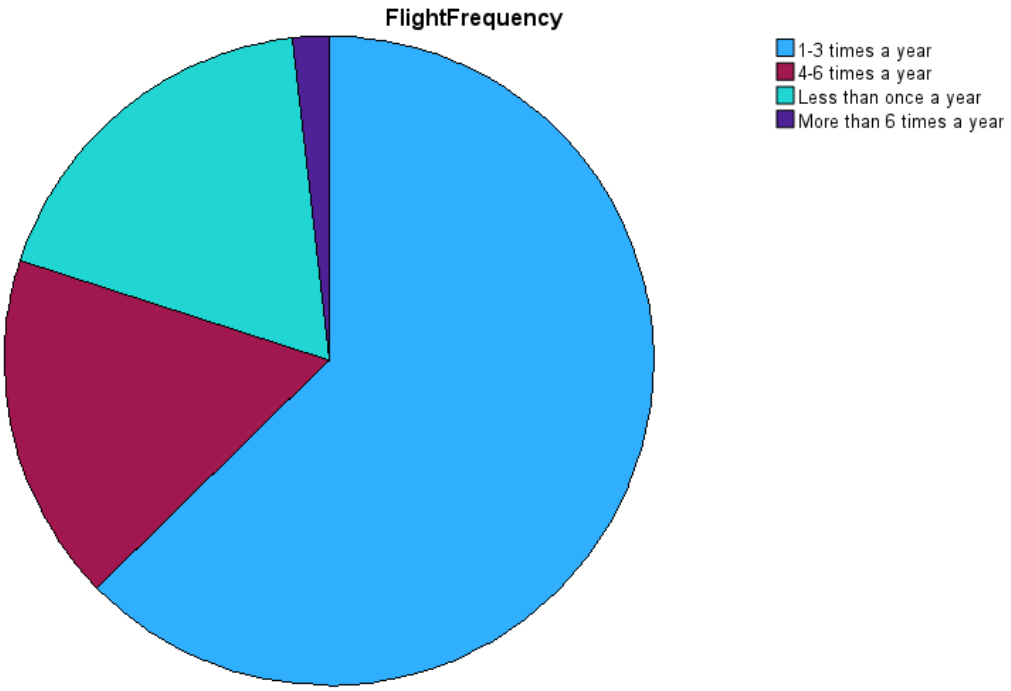
Statistics

Flight Frequency

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Flight Frequency

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	1-3 times a year	141	62.7	62.7	62.7
	4-6 times a year	39	17.3	17.3	80.0
	Less than once a year	41	18.2	18.2	98.2
	More than 6 times a year	4	1.8	1.8	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents' 62.7% are travels 1-3 times a year, 18.2% are travelling Less than once a year, 17.3% are travels 4-6 times a year and 1.8% are travels More than 6 times a year.

TABLE:4.1.5 Airlines of the respondent

FREQUENCY:

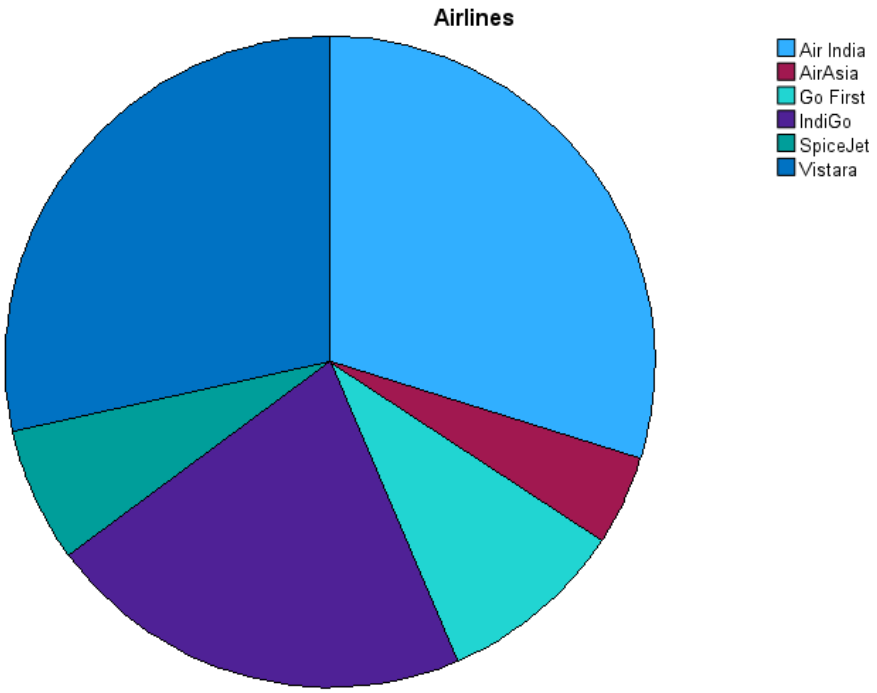
Statistics

Airlines

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Airlines

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	Air India	67	29.8	29.8	29.8
	AirAsia	10	4.4	4.4	34.2
	Go First	21	9.3	9.3	43.6
	IndiGo	48	21.3	21.3	64.9
	SpiceJet	15	6.7	6.7	71.6
	Vistara	64	28.4	28.4	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents' 29.8 are travelling in Air India,28.4% are travelling in Vistara 21.3% travelling are Indigo, 6.7% are travelling in SpiceJet, 9.3% are travelling in Go First and 4.4% are travelling in AirAsia.

TABLE:4.1.6 check in Process in Airlines

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Check-in Process:	225	2	5	3.76	.974
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

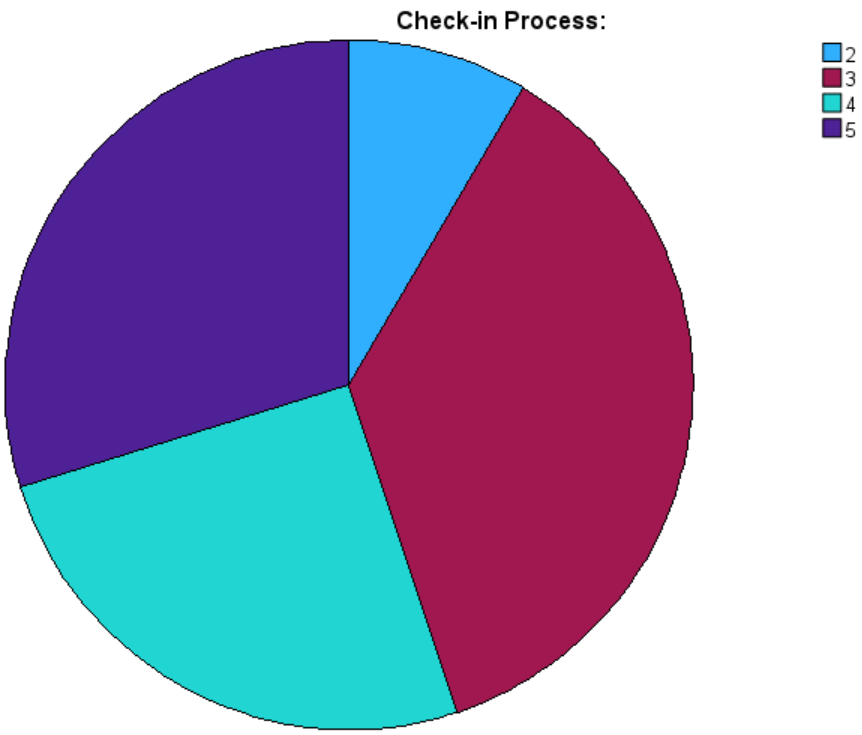
Statistics

Check-in Process:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Check-in Process:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	2	19	8.4	8.4	8.4
	3	82	36.4	36.4	44.9
	4	57	25.3	25.3	70.2
	5	67	29.8	29.8	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 29.8% are highly satisfied, 25.3%are satisfied, 36.4% are Neutral, and 8.4% are dissatisfied in check-in process.

TABLE:4.1.7 On-board Service

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
On-board Service:	225	1	5	3.74	.967
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

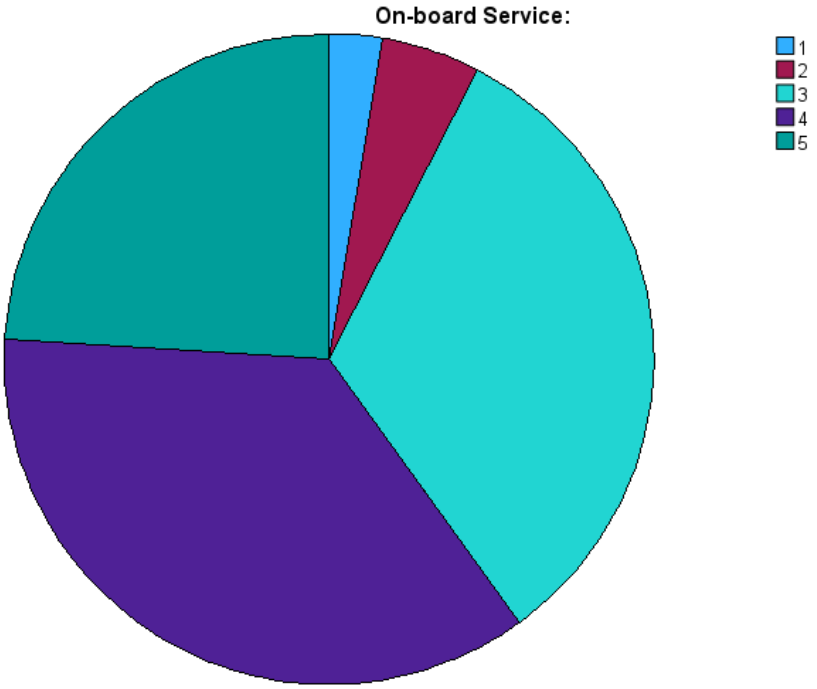
Statistics

On-board Service:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

On-board Service:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	1	6	2.7	2.7	2.7
	2	11	4.9	4.9	7.6
	3	73	32.4	32.4	40.0
	4	81	36.0	36.0	76.0
	5	54	24.0	24.0	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 24% are highly satisfied, 36% are satisfied, 32% are Neutral, 4.9% are dissatisfied and 2.7%are highly dissatisfied in On-board service.

TABLE:4.1.8 Seat Comfort in Airlines

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Seat Comfort:	225	2	5	4.01	.861
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

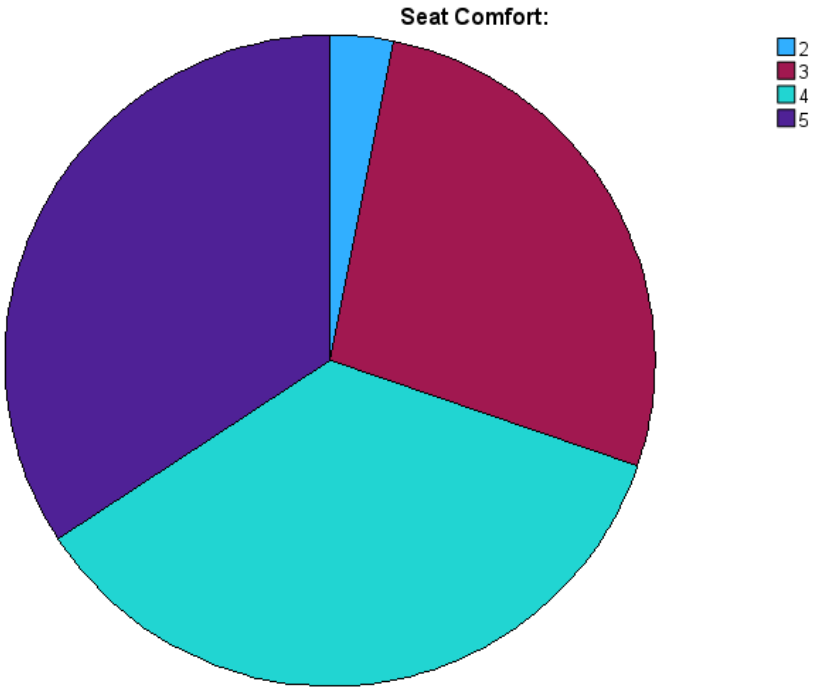
Statistics

Seat Comfort:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Seat Comfort:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	2	7	3.1	3.1	3.1
	3	61	27.1	27.1	30.2
	4	80	35.6	35.6	65.8
	5	77	34.2	34.2	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 34.2% are highly satisfied, 35.6% are satisfied, 27.1% are Neutral, 3.1% are dissatisfied and 3.3%are highly dissatisfied in seat comfort.

TABLE:4.1.9 Cleanliness in Airlines

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Cleanliness:	225	2	5	3.88	.930
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

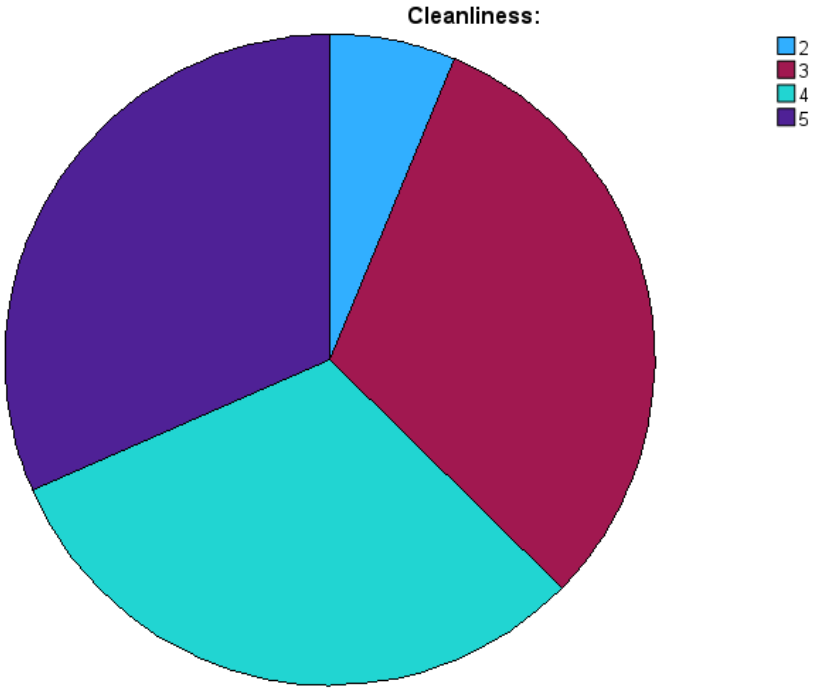
Statistics

Cleanliness:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Cleanliness:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	2	14	6.2	6.2	6.2
	3	70	31.1	31.1	37.3
	4	70	31.1	31.1	68.4
	5	71	31.6	31.6	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 31.6% are highly satisfied, 31.1% are satisfied, 31.1% Neutral, and 6.2% are dissatisfied in cleanliness of airlines

TABLE:4.1.10 Legroom in Airlines

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Legroom:	225	1	5	3.69	.935
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

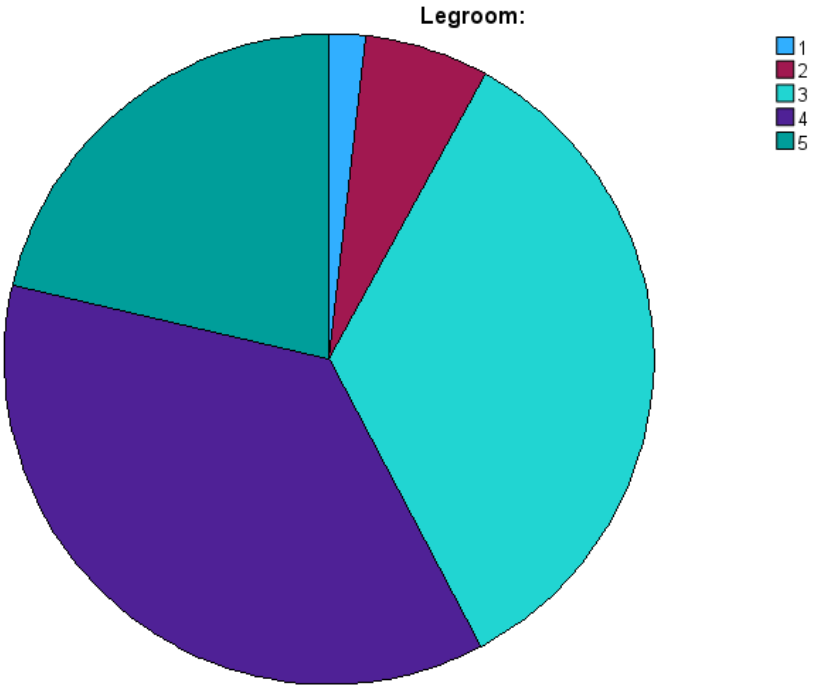
Statistics

Legroom:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Legroom:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	1	4	1.8	1.8	1.8
	2	14	6.2	6.2	8.0
	3	77	34.2	34.2	42.2
	4	82	36.4	36.4	78.7
	5	48	21.3	21.3	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 21.3% are highly satisfied, 36.4 are satisfied, 34.2% Neutral, 6.2% are dissatisfied and 1.8 %are highly dissatisfied.

TABLE:4.1.11 Food and Drinks in Airlines

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Food and drink Service:	225	2	5	3.72	.930
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

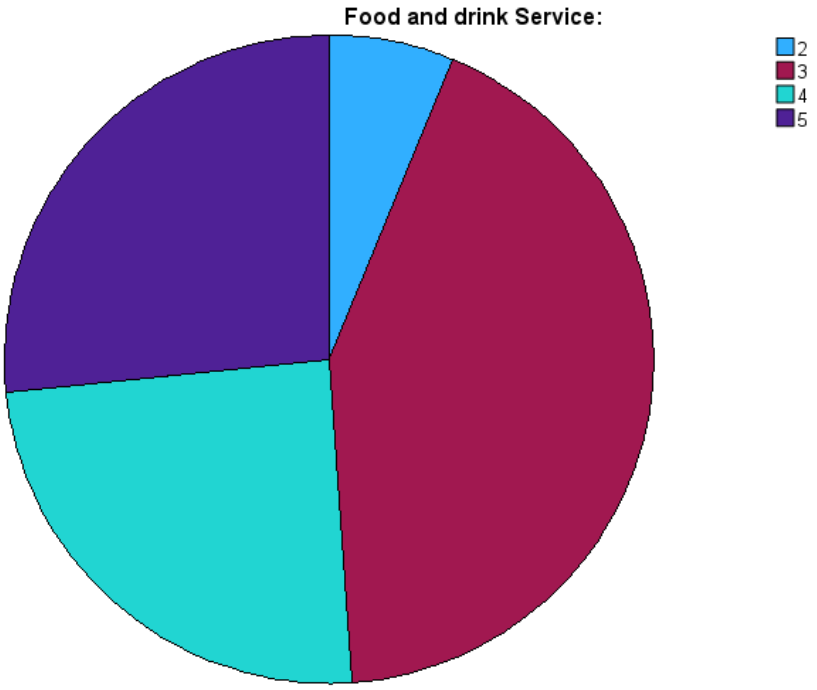
Statistics

Food and drink Service:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Food and drink Service:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	2	14	6.2	6.2	6.2
	3	96	42.7	42.7	48.9
	4	55	24.4	24.4	73.3
	5	60	26.7	26.7	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 26.7% are highly satisfied, 24.4% are satisfied, 42% Neutral, 6.2% are dissatisfied in food and drinks services.

TABLE:4.1.12 Cabin Environment in Airlines

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Cabin Environment:	225	2	5	4.01	.901
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

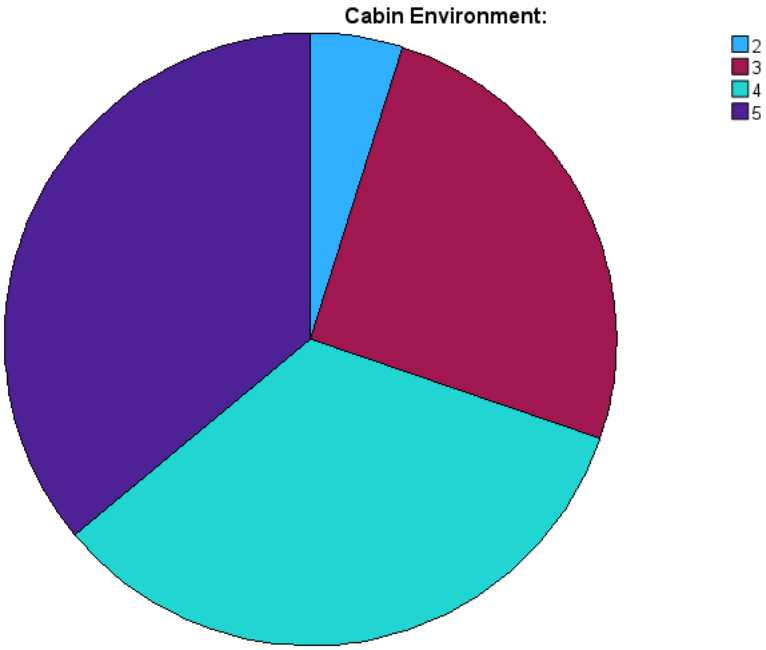
Statistics

Cabin Environment:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Cabin Environment:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	2	11	4.9	4.9	4.9
	3	57	25.3	25.3	30.2
	4	76	33.8	33.8	64.0
	5	81	36.0	36.0	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 36% are highly satisfied, 33.8% are satisfied, 25.3% Neutral, 4.9% are dissatisfied in Cabin Environment.

TABLE:4.1.13 In-flight Entertainment

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
In-flight Entertainment:	225	2	5	3.92	.956
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

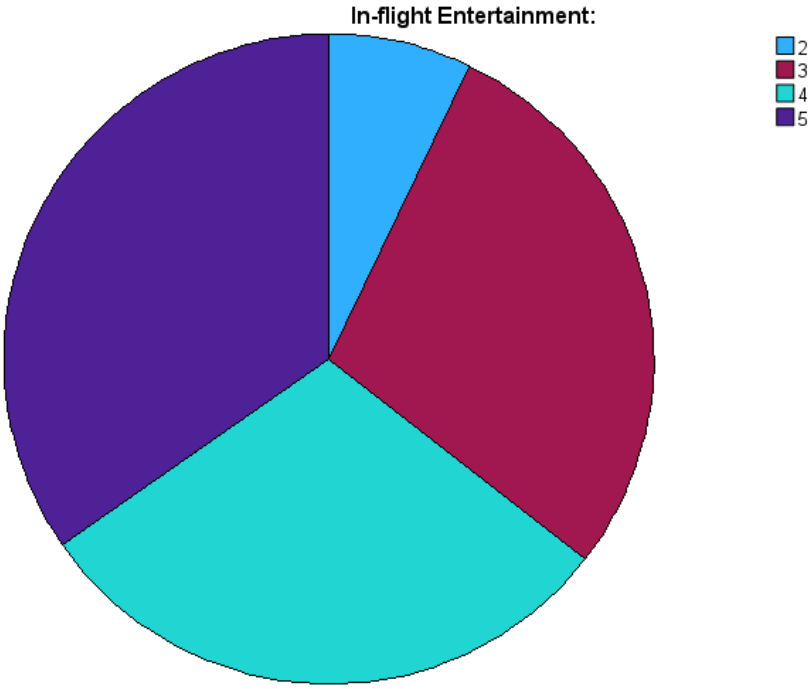
Statistics

In-flight Entertainment:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

In-flight Entertainment:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	2	16	7.1	7.1	7.1
	3	64	28.4	28.4	35.6
	4	67	29.8	29.8	65.3
	5	78	34.7	34.7	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 34.7% are highly satisfied, 29.8% are satisfied, 28.4% Neutral, 7.1% are dissatisfied in In-flight Enterainment.

TABLE:4.1.14 Baggage Handling

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Baggage Handling:	225	2	5	3.99	.933
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

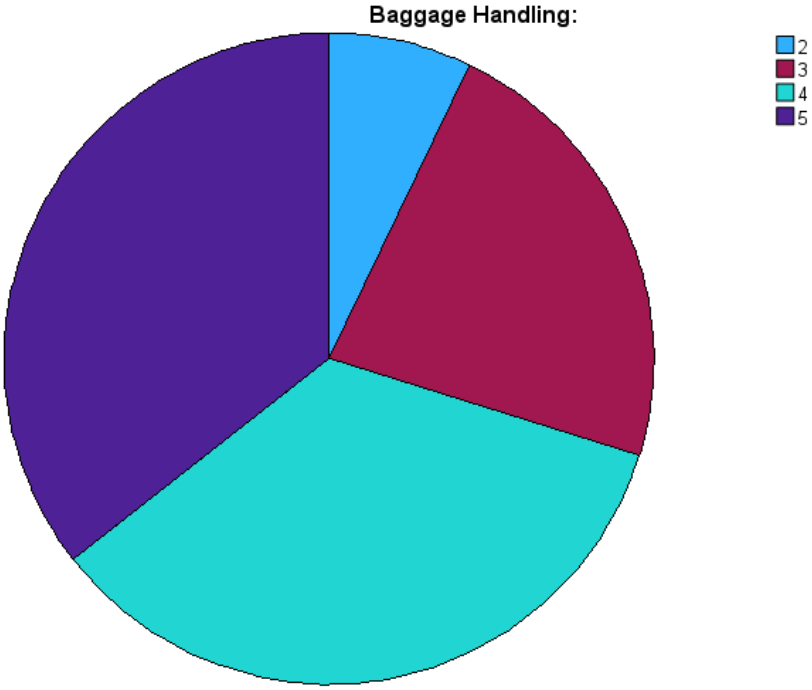
Statistics

Baggage Handling:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Baggage Handling:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	2	16	7.1	7.1	7.1
	3	51	22.7	22.7	29.8
	4	78	34.7	34.7	64.4
	5	80	35.6	35.6	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 35.6% are highly satisfied, 34.7% are satisfied, 22.7% Neutral, 7.1% are dissatisfied in Baggage Handling.

TABLE:4.1.15 Airline Preference

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Airline Preference	225	1	5	4.32	.890
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

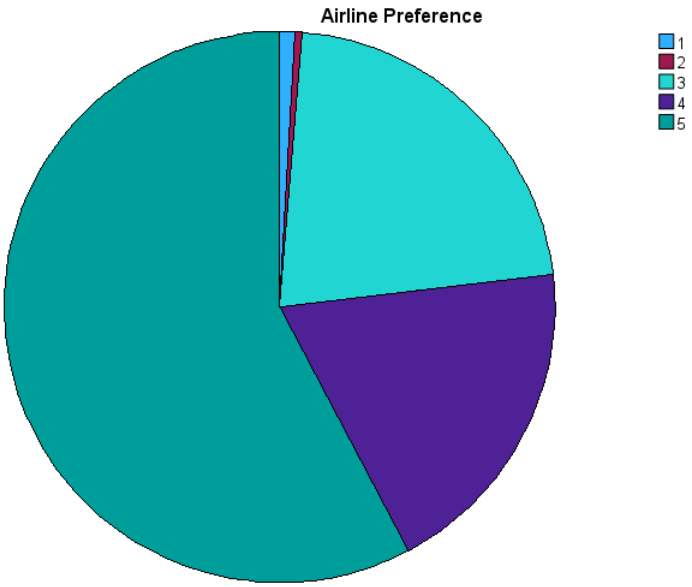
Statistics

Airline Preference

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Airline Preference

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	1	2	.9	.9	.9
	2	1	.4	.4	1.3
	3	49	21.8	21.8	23.1
	4	43	19.1	19.1	42.2
	5	130	57.8	57.8	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 57.8% are highly satisfied, 19.1% are satisfied, 21.8% Neutral, 0.4% are dissatisfied and 0.9%are highly dissatisfied in airline preference

TABLE:4.1.16 Overall Satisfaction

Descriptive Statistics

	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
Overall Satisfaction:	225	1	5	3.57	.645
Valid N (listwise)	225				

FREQUENCY:

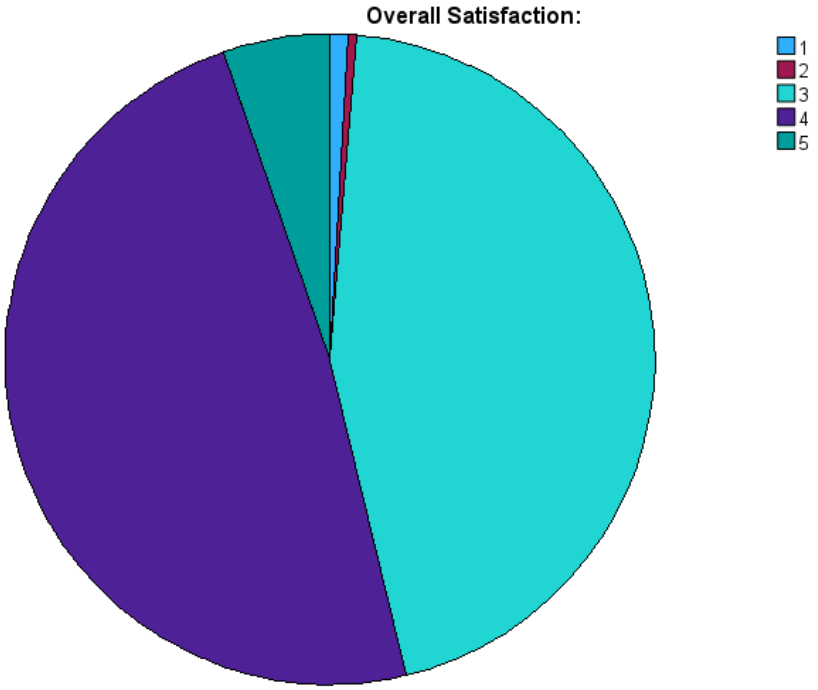
Statistics

Overall Satisfaction:

N	Valid	225
	Missing	0

Overall Satisfaction:

		Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Valid	1	2	.9	.9	.9
	2	1	.4	.4	1.3
	3	101	44.9	44.9	46.2
	4	109	48.4	48.4	94.7
	5	12	5.3	5.3	100.0
	Total	225	100.0	100.0	



INTERPRETATION: Out of 225 respondents 5.3% are highly satisfied, 48.4% are satisfied, 44.9% Neutral, 0.4% are dissatisfied and 0.9%are highly dissatisfied in overall satisfaction

HYPOTHESIS:

H0 - There is a satisfaction of passengers on service quality of different airline

H1 - There is no satisfaction of passengers on service quality of different airlines

Case Processing Summary

	Cases					
	Valid		Missing		Total	
	N	Percent	N	Percent	N	Percent
Airlines * Overall Satisfaction:	225	100.0%	0	0.0%	225	100.0%

Airlines * Overall Satisfaction: Crosstabulation

			Overall Satisfaction: 1	2	3	4	5	Total
Airlines	1	Count	0	1	28	31	7	67
		Expected Count	.6	.3	30.1	32.5	3.6	67.0
	2	Count	0	0	6	4	0	10
		Expected Count	.1	.0	4.5	4.8	.5	10.0
	3	Count	1	0	15	5	0	21
		Expected Count	.2	.1	9.4	10.2	1.1	21.0
	4	Count	0	0	16	28	4	48
		Expected Count	.4	.2	21.5	23.3	2.6	48.0
	5	Count	1	0	8	6	0	15
		Expected Count	.1	.1	6.7	7.3	.8	15.0
	6	Count	0	0	28	35	1	64
		Expected Count	.6	.3	28.7	31.0	3.4	64.0
Total		Count	2	1	101	109	12	225
		Expected Count	2.0	1.0	101.0	109.0	12.0	225.0

Chi-Square Tests

	Value	df	Asymptotic Significance (2-sided)
Pearson Chi-Square	31.651[a]	20	.047
Likelihood Ratio	30.650	20	.060
Linear-by-Linear Association	.203	1	.652
N of Valid Cases	225		

a. 20 cells (66.7%) have expected count less than 5. The minimum expected count is .04.

Correlations

		Airlines	Overall Satisfaction:
Airlines	Pearson Correlation	1	-.030
	Sig. (2-tailed)		.653
	N	225	225
Overall Satisfaction:	Pearson Correlation	-.030	1
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.653	
	N	225	225

INTERPRETATION: There is a positive correlation between Airline and Overall Ssatisfaction of passengers on service quality of different airline

CHAPTER 5

5.1 SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

- 32% of respondents have been Customer are Age between 40-49 years.
- 52% of respondents are male.
- 51.6% of respondents are travelling in Economy class.
- 62.7% of respondents are travels 1-3 times a year.
- 29.8 of respondents are travelling in Air India.
- 29.8% of respondents are highly satisfied in check in process.
- 24% of respondents are highly satisfied in On-board service.
- 34.2% of respondents are highly satisfied seat comfort.
- 31.6% of respondents are highly satisfied Cleanliness in Airlines.
- 21.3% of respondents are highly satisfied in legroom in airlines.
- 26.7% of respondents are highly satisfied in food and drinks service.
- 4.9% of respondents are dissatisfied in cabin Environment.
- 34.7% of respondents are highly satisfied in I-Flight Entertainment.
- respondents of 35.6% are highly satisfied in Baggage handling.
- 0.9% of respondents are highly dissatisfied in airline preference.
- Overall satisfaction is fulfilled for majority of respondents/ customers 48.4%.

5.2 SUGGESTION & RECOMMENDATIONS

- Lowering the price of airfare can help in retaining customers and ensuring they choose our airline over competitors.
- Implementing discounts, promotional gifts, and lucky draws for frequent flyers can enhance customer loyalty and satisfaction.
- Adjusting service charges based on individual customer needs can improve overall satisfaction and encourage repeat business.
- Cultivating strong relationships with passengers can bolster our reputation and expand our customer base, ultimately enhancing airline performance.
- Continuous improvement in customer-company relations is crucial for sustained success in the aviation industry.
- Organizing complimentary post-sale service check-up camps to identify and address any issues faced by passengers during and after their journey, thereby improving overall service quality and passenger satisfaction.

5.3 CONCLUSION

The study has explored that the most important factor while selecting a particular airline is In Flight facilities. Though the fundamental objective of airline is to provide the most basic facility that is travel in Airline because of proliferated number of players in the airline industry, airlines may enjoy new business opportunities along with highly competitive threats. The study highlights the significant and positive influence of various dimensions of airline service on both airline image and passenger satisfaction. Passengers will express satisfaction with the services provided and the overall facilities delivered by airline companies, particularly in areas such as in-flight service, Cabin Environment, and back-office operations. Among the various class of journey options, Air India airlines receive notably high ratings from passengers. Furthermore, the demographic profile analysis reveals that passengers tend to utilize flights more frequently. The study warns that a failure to deliver quality services to passengers may not only damage the formation of an airline's image but also lead to negative impacts on passengers' behavioural intentions. Therefore, it highlights the need for airline companies to employ different delivery strategies to enhance in-flight service quality. The significance of in-flight service quality as a determinant of passenger satisfaction and highlights the importance of tailored strategies to meet the diverse needs and expectations of passengers.

5.4 DIRECTIONS FOR FUTURE RESEAECH

Future research on passenger satisfaction factors and airline performance could explore cross-cultural influences on passenger perceptions, the integration of emerging technologies like AI and VR, the impact of environmental sustainability initiatives, health and safety measures post-COVID-19, the role of personalization, the rise of alternative transportation modes, the significance of employee engagement, and long-term changes in passenger behavior. These areas offer promising avenues for understanding how airlines can adapt their services and strategies to meet evolving passenger expectations, ultimately enhancing overall satisfaction and performance in the dynamic aviation industry landscape.

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APPENDICES

Airline Passenger Experience Survey: Understanding Satisfaction Factors

1. Name of passenger: _____

2. Which airline did you travel with for this survey?

a) IndiGo
b) SpiceJet
c) Air India
d) Vistara
e) GoAir (now known as Go First)

3. Date of travel: _____

Example: 7 January 2019

Personal information:

4.Age: _____

5.Gender:

a) Male
b) Female

6.Travel Class

a) Economy
b) Business
c) First Class

7. **How often do you travel by air?**

a) Less than once a year
b) 1-3 times a year
c) 4-6 times a year
d) More than 6 times a year

8.**Check-in Process:**

Were you satisfied with the efficiency of the check-in process? (Scale: 1-5)

a) 1 (Poor)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Excellent)

9. **On-board Service:**

How would you rate the on-board service provided by the airline? (Scale: 1-5)

a) 1 (Poor)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Excellent)

10.**Seat Comfort:**

a) 1 (Extremely Uncomfortable)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Extremely Comfortable)

11.**Cleanliness:**

How satisfied were you with the cleanliness of the aircraft? (Scale: 1-5)

a) 1 (Very Dissatisfied)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Very Satisfied)

12.**Legroom:**

Rate the amount of legroom available to you on the flight. (Scale: 1-5).

a) 1 (Very Cramped)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Very Spacious)

13.**Food and drink Service:**

Rate your satisfaction with the food and beverage service provided during the flight. (Scale: 1-5)

a) 1 (Poor)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Excellent)

14.**Cabin Environment:**

Rate your satisfaction with the overall cabin environment (e.g., temperature, lighting, noise level). (Scale: 1-5)

a) 1 (Very Dissatisfied)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Very satisfied)

15.**In-flight Entertainment:**

How satisfied were you with the in-flight entertainment options? (Scale: 1-5)

a) 1 (Very Dissatisfied)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Very satisfied)

16.**Baggage Handling:** How satisfied were you with the handling of your baggage? (Scale: 1-5)

a) 1 (Poor)
b) 2
c) 3
d) 4
e) 5 (Excellent)

17.**How likely are you to choose this airline for your future travels?**

a) Very Likely
b) Likely
c) Neutral
d) Unlikely
e) Very Unlikely

18.**Overall Satisfaction:** How satisfied were you with your overall experience on this flight?

a) Very Satisfied
b) satisfied
c) Neutral
d) Dissatisfied
e) Very Dissatisfied

19. **Additional Feedback:**

Please share any additional comments, suggestions, or feedback you may have regarding your flight experience:

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